

Chapter 51-5

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Time flew by quickly, and soon it was Saturday.

The button Liang Shi had sent to the expert for authentication hadn't yielded results yet. These past few days, only Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe had contacted her, both comforting her emotionally.

She just smiled as if nothing had happened and said: "It's okay."

She hadn't asked about Qiu Zimin, and the other party hadn't contacted her either.

Saturday was the day for her costume fitting photoshoot. This drama was called "Afterglow."

She had defeated Chen Liuying and a crowd of popular idols to compete for this antagonist role.

When Liang Shi arrived at the photography studio, it was still early. As a newcomer actress, she didn't have her own makeup room yet, so she squeezed into the communal makeup room to get her makeup done.

The leads were photographed first. Zhao Ying needed to shoot two versions—one as the early fragile princess pea¹, and another as her grown-up appearance later on, for individual poster shots.

It wasn't until near noon that it was Liang Shi's turn. She wore all black, with rose gold chain glasses. With her slim waist and long legs, wearing the black suit gave her that refined scoundrel vibe.

After seeing her styling and makeup, Zhao Ying couldn't help but sigh: "You're the antagonist herself."

Liang Shi just smiled: "Sister Ying, please don't tease me."

She hadn't shot this type of thing in a long time, so at first she couldn't quite get the hang of it. But after two NGs², she got into character and easily captured the camera's attention. Just one look was enough to express the character's essence.

Even the director couldn't help saying to Zhao Ying: "This one's got potential."

Zhao Ying was proud: "Of course, I picked her out at first glance."

Just as Zhao Ying finished speaking, the click-clack of high heels came through, especially clear on the smooth marble tiles.

The director turned around and saw the investor's wife. He immediately changed his demeanor and went over to greet her: "Mrs. Qi."

The woman wore a blue-green qipao³, her slender legs exposed to the air. Even though she was over fifty, she still had her charm.

Zhao Ying had always disdained dealing with these investors. Her family was wealthy—if she wanted, she could be an investor herself any minute.

So she found a spot to sit and watch Liang Shi's photoshoot.

Liang Shi's costume fitting photos were shot quickly. After finishing, she came down, originally wanting to find Zhao Ying, but her expression changed when she saw the person next to the director.

She frowned, her gaze meeting exactly with Mrs. Qi's incoming look.

Their eyes met.

Footnotes:

¹ Princess pea: Reference to "The Princess and the Pea" fairy tale, suggesting someone delicate and sensitive.

² NG: "No Good" - film industry term for a failed take that needs to be reshot.

³ Qipao: A traditional Chinese dress, also known as cheongsam, characterized by its high collar and form-fitting silhouette.